

Beds made by young people, for their own community

Youth employment

Community organisations are encouraged to pay a local crew, and build days open the work to any young person.

Good Design

The bed was designed in community. First Peoples' knowledge sets how it is made and used.

Authentic Giving

The community organisation decides who works, what they are paid and where beds go.

Seeing the Bigger Picture

Floors, no local work and plastic with nowhere to go are one problem, answered with one product.

The problem

In remote Aboriginal communities young people leave because there is no work where they live. Families sleep on floors because a bed cannot be bought locally and freight costs more than the bed. Plastic sits outside any kerbside collection and goes to landfill.

What goes in

\$99,750 buys 133 Stretch Beds at \$750. Making, freight and community work sit inside the price. The design, the press and the build method from Goods on Country. Young people, and the decisions, from 4 community organisations.

Where we start

540 beds in homes across 11 communities. 320 bought and paid for by four organisations. Forty pressed at our own facility and assembled in Maningrida by local young workers. VERIFIED

IMPACT	WHAT WE DO	WHAT IT PRODUCES	WHAT CHANGES IN 12 MONTHS	WHAT IT LEADS TO	HOW WE COUNT IT
Young people, build days	Open build days in each community, with the community organisation and, in Maningrida, Homeland School Company. Any young person can come, learn the build and take home their own family's bed.	About 100 young people take part across 4 communities. TARGET	Young people build the bed their own family sleeps on, and learn a build from start to finish. TARGET	Build days become a regular local program the organisation runs itself. PATHWAY	Build days logged by date, place and who took part, with recorded consent.
Youth employment	We recommend and encourage each community organisation to employ a small local crew to run the build days and deliver the beds, paid from the community work inside each bed's price. The organisation decides.	Paid local crews, where each organisation chooses to employ one. TARGET	Crew members earn, and hold a record of paid work and a trade they can teach. TARGET	Making roles at a community production facility, where one is funded separately. PATHWAY	The production log: crew paid, hours against completed beds.
Households off the floor	Beds go to households the community organisation chooses.	133 beds placed, each recorded against a community and a date. TARGET	People sleep off the floor on a bed they can wash and repair. TARGET	Beds still in use at three months. We claim no health outcome. TARGET	The asset register, and follow-ups at delivery, six weeks and three months.
Plastic recycled	Waste plastic is shredded and pressed into bed legs.	About 2.66 tonnes of plastic in 133 beds. MODELLED	Plastic that had nowhere to go becomes a product that stays in use. TARGET	Local plastic feeds a local press. We would welcome testing whether Décor plastics can feed it too; that is not yet tested. PATHWAY	Shred weighed in and parts weighed out, every batch.
Community enterprise	The beds become the organisation's first trading stock, about 33 each, sold to buyers who hold health and housing budgets.	4 organisations holding stock. TARGET	Each makes a first sale and keeps the full price. TARGET	Sales pay for the next lot, and the making moves toward community ownership. PATHWAY	Sales reported by each organisation. Nothing returns to Goods on Country.

The change we are working toward

Young people have work where they live, families sleep off the floor, and the making, the work and the money stay in community.

What has to be true

The community organisation wants the work and sets the terms. If it does not, beds move to another community where a partner is in place. Buyers keep paying \$750, as 320 beds on invoice already show. Young people choose to take part and can stop at any time, under the child safe practice in the application. Ownership of the making is a pathway. We do not claim it has moved until the community holds the keys, runs the payroll and invoices the buyer.

Labels: verified is on a record today; modelled is calculated from the build; target is what this grant sets out to do; pathway depends on more than this grant. This page covers the 133 beds this grant buys and nothing else.